ANX-04 | Therapist guide only

Professional planning for an agreed activity

ANX-04 | A flexible therapist framework, guided by assessment and agreements.

Purpose

Record with the client an adapted step toward an avoided meaningful activity. The sheets only support recording after professional suitability assessment; they are not an exposure protocol or instructions for independent use.

Before use

Relevant therapist training, suitable formulation, safety assessment and consent are required. Assess circumstances, relevant health status, access and support as needed within professional scope. Do not use an activity to prove fear unjustified.

A possible working sequence

Open with SES-S01 as needed and close with SES-S02, feedback and a clear plan.

1. Explore what activity matters to the client and what they want to develop.

2. State an expectation to learn about without assuming the outcome.

3. Plan a step and conditions suited to the assessment, current wishes and ability.

4. Retain necessary protection and support, with options to reduce, postpone or stop.

5. Check understanding, agree on recording and when to return to the therapist before deciding next steps.

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Examples for exploration, not ready-made tasks

Examples are fictional. A real client's circumstances, needs and wishes take priority.

Group	A conversation example
Children	A child wants to join a familiar game but fears not understanding. The therapist explores a defined part and an adult's role, keeping explanations and help available.
Adolescents	A teenager wants to start a delayed draft. Consider a specific part she chooses, without unagreed submission or publication.
Adults	An adult wants to resume familiar leisure. After suitability assessment, consider part of the activity under agreed conditions; do not assume more is better.
Older adults	A person wants to attend a familiar gathering. Explore conditions and support by preference and need, without measuring success by reduced accompaniment.

A key distinction

Examples illustrate discussion, not ready-made assignments. The kit provides no exposure hierarchy, dosage, distress threshold or instruction to continue until anxiety drops. Do not create real danger, alter medical care or remove necessary protection.

A question for shared reflection

Do the activity and conditions suit this person now, and do they understand the choice and options to change or stop?

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Individual adaptation and scope

An age label does not replace assessment of development, communication, context and preferences.

Group	A possible approach
Children, approximately ages 6 to 11	Use a concrete situation and one question at a time. The therapist can write spoken answers and check understanding. Hear the child's voice too. Adult roles, sharing and consent depend on the setting and need; do not promise absolute confidentiality.
Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17	Choose a personal focus and recording method that respects privacy. Explore setting, demands and relationships. Explain sharing and consent limits, and arrange help without making practice a test or demand for obedience.
Adults	Include roles, culture, language, circumstances and resources as described. Do not assume time, money or support is available. Shared choice does not replace clinical suitability assessment.
Older adults	Use respectful adult language, comfortable pace and spacing. Ask about preferred completion methods and help without assuming reduced ability or family dependence. Life experience and preferences inform the work.

Checking understanding and choice

Ask the client to explain their understanding and choice in their words. Shorten, leave fields blank or answer aloud. If questions are unsuitable or burdensome, adapt the approach rather than require completion.

This unit's specific boundary

Do not use this general series as an OCD, trauma or universal anxiety protocol. Work within a suitable model and training. If no appropriate activity is possible, choose assessment or another tool instead of a task merely to complete the form.

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Practice, follow-up and professional review

Practice is chosen jointly; the sheet does not automatically authorize action.

Before practice

Record the plan in ANX-04-W and needed reminders in ANX-04-P during the session. Agree on returning to the therapist if conditions change. The follow-up sheet does not authorize expansion, repetition at a set frequency or independent choice of another activity.

Back in the session

Review the plan, actual actions and actual conditions. Not attempting, stopping and remaining anxiety inform suitability assessment. Examine functioning and participation alongside experience, not only anxiety reduction. ANX-05 reviews learning before any new decision.

Production and review status

Original draft guide and sheets. Professional review for each age and a rights review are needed before distribution. Completed writing is not clinical approval; the kit has not been validated or tested for effectiveness.

General sources for further reading

NICE CG113 — adults
Professional framework for adult generalized anxiety: assessment, functioning and work by trained therapists. It does not validate these six units or their use with children.
https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/cg113/chapter/Recommendations

NIMH — child anxiety, 2024
Research background on CBT for children; the study used a different protocol. It does not approve this wording or these age adaptations.
https://www.nimh.nih.gov/news/science-updates/2024/cognitive-behavioral-therapy-alters-brain-activity-in-children-with-anxiety

Consulted: 03 Nov 2026. Background sources only, without permission to copy forms or validation of the kit.

Reviewer's name, role, date and versions reviewed:

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